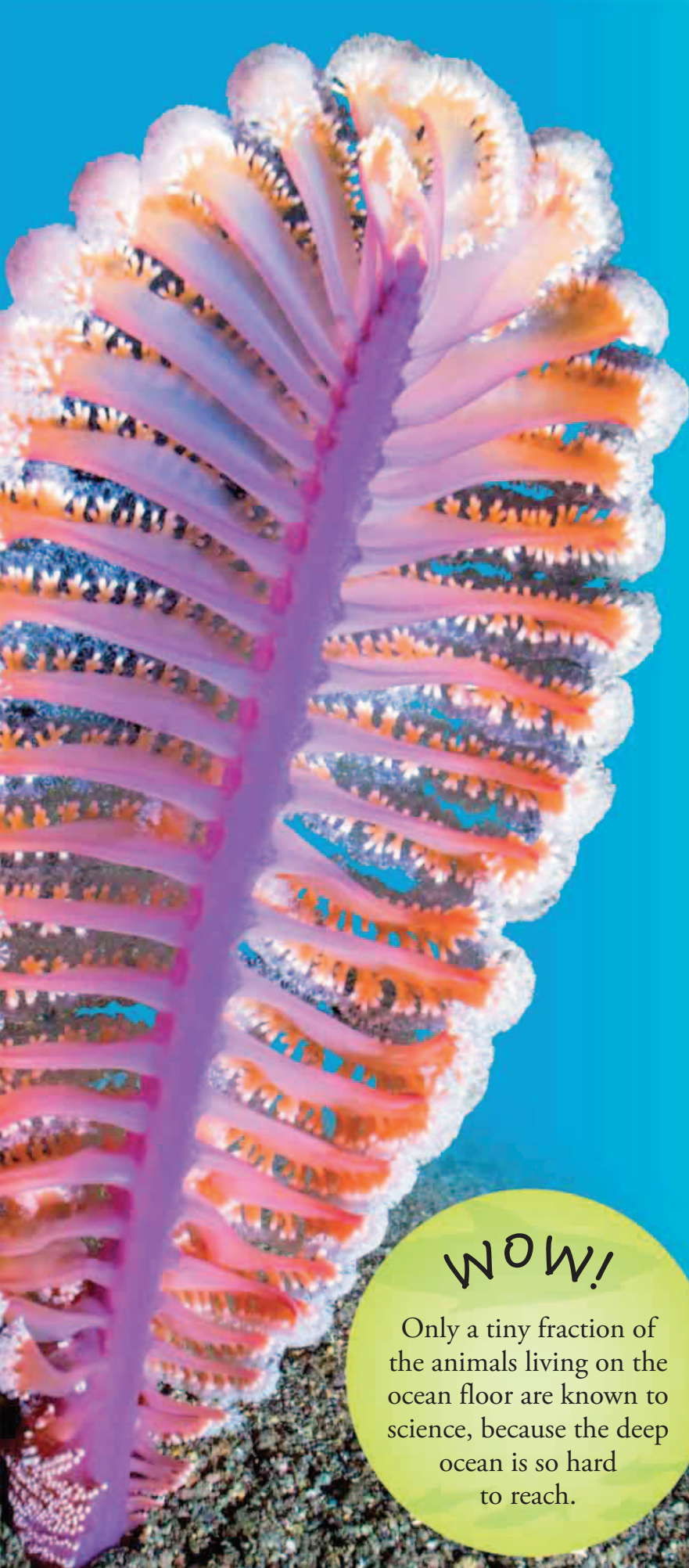




SIFTING THE WATER

Some animals sit in one place on the ocean floor and sift the water for drifting food particles. These creatures include sea pens and relatives of starfish called feather stars and basket stars. They attach themselves to the soft seabed, and use their feathery arms to gather anything edible carried past them by the deepwater currents.



◀ SEA PEN

So-called because it looks like a quill pen made from a feather, the sea pen sifts food from the water flowing through its tentacles.

▲ BASKET STAR

Like its starfish relatives, this basket star collects food with short, mobile "tube feet" that pass it to its central mouth.



STANDING AROUND

The strange tripodfish has three very long, stiff spines on its lower fins, which it uses to stand on the ocean floor. Facing into the current and high above the soft ooze, it is perfectly placed to seize any food carried its way by the water. So even though it can swim, the tripod fish can get all the food it needs without moving.

WOW!

Only a tiny fraction of the animals living on the ocean floor are known to science, because the deep ocean is so hard to reach.

